

COLLECTION · QUÉBEC & LEGAL

Home and title insurance

*Protecting yourself well — the insurance to know
when buying*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It offers general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. As every real estate situation is different, it is recommended that you consult the appropriate professionals before making any decision regarding a real estate transaction.

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Home and title insurance

Protecting yourself well — the insurance to know when buying

Two insurances protect your purchase from different angles: home insurance (against losses) and title insurance (against legal problems tied to the property). Understanding them means avoiding costly protection gaps.

This guide explains both, what they cover, and why they matter.

Informational content. Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page.

Two insurances protect your purchase from different angles: home (against losses) and title (against legal problems). This guide explains both, how to shop well and how to react after a loss.

Understanding them means avoiding costly protection gaps.

CHAPTER

Home insurance

Protecting the building and your belongings.

Home insurance covers your property and your belongings against risks like fire, water damage or theft, and includes **civil liability** (damage caused to others).

It must be in force **from the moment you take possession** — lenders require it before disbursing the mortgage. Take the time to check:

- The **coverages** included and the **exclusions**.
- The amount of the **deductibles**.
- The situations that affect insurability (oil tank, aging roof, flood zone).

Home insurance covers the property and your belongings (fire, water damage, theft) and includes civil liability. It must be active from the moment you take possession — lenders require it. Check coverages, exclusions and deductibles, and flag anything that complicates insurability (oil tank, aging roof, flood zone).

EMILIE'S TIP

Get your insurance quote as soon as the promise to purchase is accepted. A hard-to-insure property is better discovered before signing than after.

CHAPTER

Title insurance

Protecting yourself against legal problems.

Title insurance is different: it protects against certain **problems tied to the property title** rather than against physical losses.

- A title defect or an undetected irregularity.
- An encroachment or non-compliance.
- Real estate fraud.

It can sometimes replace or complement a recent location certificate, depending on the case. It's a one-time protection (a single premium) often offered by the notary at signing.

Title insurance, for its part, protects against legal problems with the title: a title defect, an encroachment, non-compliance, fraud. It's a one-time protection (a single premium), often offered by the notary, which can sometimes complement a location certificate depending on the case.

EMILIE'S TIP

Title insurance isn't mandatory, but for a few hundred dollars just once, it can save you a costly dispute. Ask your notary whether it's relevant in your case.

CHAPTER

Two complementary protections

Combining the coverages intelligently.

The two insurances don't replace each other: they cover different angles.

- **Home:** losses and liability — mandatory for the lender.
- **Title:** legal property problems — optional but often useful.

The goal: that no significant risk is left uncovered. Also remember to reassess your coverage after major renovations that increase the property's value.

The two don't replace each other: home covers losses (mandatory for the lender), title covers the legal side (optional but useful). The goal: that no significant risk stays uncovered. Reassess your coverage after major renovations.

EMILIE'S TIP

List what each insurance covers, side by side. You'll see immediately whether there's a “gap” between the two — and that's exactly where the nasty surprises hide.

CHAPTER

Shopping well for home insurance

Paying the right price for the right protection.

Premiums vary a lot from one insurer to another for similar coverage. A few reflexes:

- Compare **several quotes** for equivalent protection.
- Adjust the **deductible**: higher, it reduces the premium (but increases your share in the event of a claim).
- Take advantage of **discounts** (auto-home bundle, alarm system, non-smoker).
- Honestly declare the **risks**: an omission can void the coverage.

The cheapest protection is only useful if it covers what you actually need.

Premiums vary a lot for similar coverage: compare several quotes, adjust the deductible, take advantage of discounts (bundling, alarm) and honestly declare the risks (an omission can void the coverage). The cheapest is only useful if it covers what you need.

EMILIE'S TIP

Don't choose your insurance on price alone. Too high a deductible "to save" can cost you a lot the day of a water leak. Look at the protection before the price.

CHAPTER

After a loss: reacting without stress

Knowing what to do when the time comes.

Good preparation makes a loss far less painful:

1. **Secure** the premises and limit the damage (shut off the water, for example).
2. **Document**: photos, videos, a list of the affected belongings.
3. **Notify** your insurer quickly.
4. Keep the **receipts** for the expenses incurred.

An up-to-date inventory of your belongings (photos, invoices) greatly speeds up the settlement. Do it once, calmly, before you need it.

After a loss: secure the premises, document (photos, videos, a list), notify the insurer quickly and keep the receipts. An up-to-date inventory of your belongings greatly speeds up the settlement — film a walk-through of your home once a year, drawers open, before you need it.

EMILIE'S TIP

Film a walk-through of your home once a year, drawers and cupboards open. In the event of a loss, that video is worth a thousand forms to prove what you owned.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Get a home insurance quote.
2. Check anything that complicates insurability.

Within 30 days

1. Discuss title insurance with the notary.
2. Make sure there's no protection gap.

Next

1. Reassess your insurance after renovations.

To do

1. Get a home insurance quote as soon as the promise is accepted.
2. Discuss title insurance with the notary and check that no risk is left uncovered.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Home insurance: covers losses and liability, mandatory for the lender.
 - Title insurance: covers legal problems tied to the property.
 - Deductible: the amount you bear in the event of a claim.
 - Insurability: how easily a property can be insured based on its condition and risks.
 - Civil liability: protection in the event of damage caused to others.
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- Home insurance: covers losses and liability, required by the lender.
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GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. Home insurance covers:

- A) Title problems
- B) Losses and civil liability
- C) The Welcome Tax
- D) The notary

2. It must be in force:

- A) A year after the purchase
- B) From the moment you take possession
- C) Never
- D) Only for condos

3. Title insurance protects against:

- A) Fire
- B) Legal problems tied to the property
- C) Theft
- D) Taxes

4. Title insurance is:

- A) Mandatory
- B) Optional but often useful
- C) Forbidden
- D) Free

5. The two insurances:

- A) Replace each other
- B) Cover different angles and complement each other
- C) Are identical
- D) Are useless

6. After major renovations, you must:

- A) Do nothing
- B) Reassess your insurance
- C) Cancel it
- D) Pay a fine

7. A higher deductible:

- A) Increases the premium
- B) Reduces the premium but increases your share in a claim
- C) Has no effect
- D) Is illegal

8. Failing to declare a risk can:

- A) Reduce the premium risk-free
- B) Void the coverage
- C) Double the protection
- D) Be required

9. After a loss, you must first:

- A) Throw everything out
- B) Secure the premises and document the damage
- C) Wait a year
- D) Sell the house

10. To speed up a settlement, it helps to have:

- A) No documents
- B) An up-to-date inventory (photos, invoices)
- C) A new notary
- D) A bigger mortgage

Answer key

- 1. **B** — Losses and liability (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — Required by the lender from possession (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — Title defect, fraud, encroachment (ch. 2).
- 4. **B** — Optional, a single premium (ch. 2).
- 5. **B** — Complementary (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — The value changes (ch. 3).
- 7. **B** — A premium/deductible trade-off (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — Declare honestly (ch. 4).

9. B — Secure then document (ch. 5).

10. B — A prior inventory (ch. 5).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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